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Summary of stakeholders' submissions on Papua New Guinea*

Report of the Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Human Rights

I. Background

1. The present report was prepared pursuant to Human Rights Council resolutions 5/1 and 16/21, taking into consideration the periodicity of the universal periodic review and the outcome of the previous review.[1] It is a summary of 19 stakeholders' submissions.[2] for the universal periodic review, presented in a summarized manner owing to word-limit constraints.

II. Information provided by stakeholders

A. Scope of international obligations and cooperation with human rights mechanisms

2. AI recommended that Papua New Guinea ratify the remaining core human rights treaties, seek international cooperation and assistance to incorporate these treaties into domestic law and submit, without further delay, overdue state party reports to the treaty bodies.[3] JS9 recommended that PNG ratify the Second Optional Protocol to the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights, aiming at the abolition of the death penalty, and subsequently amend any remaining domestic legislation, including the Constitution and the Criminal Code Act (1974), that may indirectly reference or enable the reintroduction of the death penalty.[4] JS5 recommend that Papua New Guinea ratify the ILO Indigenous and Tribal Peoples Convention No. 169.[5]

3. ECLJ recommended that Papua New Guinea ratify the Protocol to Prevent, Suppress and Punish Trafficking in Persons, Especially Women and Children, supplementing the United Nations Convention against Transnational Organized Crime.[6] JS8 recommended that Papua New Guinea accede the Rome Statue of the International Criminal Court and undertake a comprehensive legal review to ensure compatibility of the domestic legislation with it.[7] ICAN recommended that Papua New Guinea ratify the United Nations Treaty on the Prohibition of Nuclear Weapons.[8]

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4. JS2 recommended that Papua New Guinea extend a standing invitation to all UN Special Procedure mandate holders.[9]

B. National human rights framework

1. Constitutional and legislative framework

5. JS6 noted that the Family Protection Act (2013), the Criminal Code Act, and the Cybercrime Act (2016) required substantive amendments to reflect international human rights standards, address emerging forms of violence, and ensure effective deterrence.[10]

2. Institutional infrastructure and policy measures

6. Three submissions noted the absence of a National Human Rights Institution (NHRI) in line with the Principles Relating to the Status of National Human Rights Institutions (Paris Principles), despite repeated commitments to establish one.[11] Several submissions recommended establishing and operationalizing an independent NHRI with adequate funding and broad mandate.[12] ICO recommended that Papua New Guinea strengthen its legal mandate, independence, and provincial outreach to ensure effective monitoring, reporting, and response to human rights violations across all regions.[13] JAI called for empowering it to investigate acts by state and non-state actors, including police violence, gender-based violence, and harms linked to extractive industries and climate impacts.[14]

7. JS3 noted the need to strengthen the National Mechanism for Implementation, Reporting and Follow-up by improving inter-agency coordination and engagement with civil society organizations and local communities.[15]

8. AI reported that Papua New Guinea lacked credible and updated statistical data to track improvements or regression on human rights issues. Similarly, JS3 highlighted the limited data on implementation of UPR recommendations, hindering progress assessment.[16] Several submissions called for enhanced data collection, including disaggregated data on vulnerable groups.[17]

C. Promotion and protection of human rights

1. Implementation of international human rights obligations, taking into account applicable international humanitarian law

Equality and non-discrimination

9. ICO recommended addressing intersectional discrimination affecting women, girls, youth, and persons with disabilities in these communities by strengthening their participation in decision-making and improving access to services and protection mechanisms.[18]

10. AI noted that the PNG had a Constitution with a Bill of Rights that lacked human rights protection in some areas, and that it did not have a comprehensive anti-discrimination.[19] It recommended that Papua New Guinea amend the Bill of Rights and adopt comprehensive legislation prohibiting discrimination on the basis of sexual orientation and gender identity.[20]

11. JS4 recommended that it enact dedicated anti-discrimination legislation protecting people living with HIV.[21]

Right to life, liberty and security of person, and freedom from torture

12. AI reported escalating violence in Papua New Guinea resulting in loss of life, homes and livelihoods, causing internal displacement and leading to violations of the rights of women and children.[22] CSOLC4UPR reported that the proliferation of high-powered firearms was a critical driver of escalating violence in the country, and that clans-contracted mercenaries had made the conflict deadlier, more widespread, and sexual violence easier to perpetrate.[23] AI referred to a report highlighting that children as young as eight were involved in fighting, using high-powder guns trafficked or sold by security forces.[24]

13. AI recommended that Papua New Guinea ensure adequate law and order resources to address conflict, particularly in Enga Province and other parts of the Highlands, hold perpetrators accountable, and ensure inclusive participation of affected individuals in peacebuilding. [25] CSOLC4UPR recommended that the country enact and enforce comprehensive firearms legislation prohibiting military-grade weapons in civilian hands; exclude sexual violence perpetrators from any amnesty; and develop a comprehensive disarmament, demobilization and reintegration framework incorporating gender analysis and women's participation.[26] JAI recommended that Papua New Guinea address escalating tribal violence and displacement through rights-based, climate-responsive approaches, and adopt a national framework for tribal and inter-ethnic violence in the Highlands, integrating conflict prevention, land dispute resolution, arms control, and protection for displaced persons.[27]

14. CSOLC4UPR reported a sharp increase in sorcery accusation-related violence (SARV) between 2022 and 2024.[28] JS10 reported that such accusations disproportionately targeted women, children, older persons, persons with disabilities, and other marginalized groups, resulting in beatings, torture, killings, forced displacement, the breakdown of families and communities.[29] Two submissions reported continued barriers to justice for victims of sorcery accusation-related violence.[30]

15. JS10 recommended that Papua New Guinea strengthen legislation to provide comprehensive protection against SARV. JS6 recommended that Papua New Guinea amend the Criminal Code Act to introduce enhanced penalties for SARV.[31] JS1 recommended that Papua New Guinea ensure funding for the SARV National Action Plan, while JS6 called for special attention to women, children, and persons with acquired disabilities in its implementation.[32]

16. Several submissions recommended that Papua New Guinea strengthen investigations, prosecutions and law enforcement capacity to combat SARV, including through training on human rights, gender-based violence, child protection.[33] JS3 recommended improving access to justice and support services, particularly in rural and underserved areas, including legal aid, shelters, and psychosocial support.[34] Four submissions recommended that Papua New Guinea establish awareness-raising programmes with local communities to eliminate harmful practices.[35]

17. AI reported that sex work was criminalized, resulting in high levels of violence and stigma, with crimes against sex workers not taken seriously, and discrimination in accessing health care. AI recommended that Papua New Guinea decriminalize sex work and related activities, and that organizations working with them were not targeted by law enforcement agencies.[36]

18. CGNK reported that despite Papua New Guinea's adoption of the National Mental Health Policy (2021–2030) and a shift towards suicide prevention, suicide remained criminalized under Article 311 of the Criminal Code Act. It added that the legal framework undermined effective suicide prevention by reinforcing stigma, discouraging help-seeking, and limiting access to care. It recommended that Papua New Guinea urgently decriminalize suicide attempts to strengthen prevention efforts.[37]

Administration of justice, including impunity, and the rule of law

19. JAI reported that severe understaffing, underfunding, and lack of basic operational resources limited the capacity of the police to provide effective and rights-respecting security services. This contributed to repeated incidents of violence by security forces, including during crowd control operations and detention, with few investigations or prosecutions. The authorization of aggressive policing measures in volatile regions raised further concern given the long-standing absence of accountability mechanisms.[38] AI reported that the Ombudsman Commission and the Internal Investigations Division could receive complaints about police misconduct but lacked sufficient resources, powers and independence to carry out these functions effectively. AI reported that, in 2024, the Ombudsman Commission concluded its eight-year-long investigation into the police shooting at university students protesting corruption in June 2016 and that the individual police officers had not been prosecuted in this case.[39]

20. JAI further reported that corrupt practices across the government contributed to widespread impunity and the erosion of public confidence in state institutions. It added that implementation of anti-corruption strategies had been inconsistent and constrained by limited institutional capacity.[40] JAI recommended that Papua New Guinea take concrete steps to address impunity within law enforcement and ensure prompt and independent investigations into allegations of police brutality and corruption. It further stated that anti-corruption institutions, including the Independent Commission Against Corruption, should be fully resourced and insulated from political interference.[41]

21. JS4 reported that female inmates lacked adequate access to legal aid and legal representation, a particularly grave concern where female prisoners were themselves victims of sexual offences committed within custodial settings. It recommended that Papua New Guinea fund and operationalise legal aid services within all custodial facilities accommodating women, with particular attention to female inmates victims of sexual offences.[42] Two submissions reported that access to justice remained a challenge for other marginalised groups, including women, children, people living with HIV, persons with disabilities, and survivors of violence.[43]

22. JS6 recommended that Papua New Guinea conduct targeted awareness-raising programmes on disability rights, gender-based violence, and SARV at village courts, police stations, and provincial courthouses.[44]

Fundamental freedoms and the right to participate in public and political life

23. AI reported that women's public participation and representation in leadership roles remained low, with only three of the 111 parliamentary representatives being women.[45]

24. ICO reported that structural barriers limited the meaningful participation of Indigenous, rural and minority communities in decision-making processes, resulting in weak representation and limited influence over policies affecting land and development. It further reported that election-related violence, insecurity and displacement in the Highlands region, undermined political participation and reduced voter turnout among Indigenous and minority communities. ICO recommended that Papua New Guinea strengthen the meaningful participation of Indigenous, rural and minority communities in political and decision-making processes and ensure safe and inclusive electoral processes in conflict-affected and remote regions.[46]

25. JS2 reported that authorities had restricted or criminalised assemblies under broadly defined provisions under the Criminal Code Act. It further reported the lack of accountability for the unlawful shooting in Jiwaka Province in 2022 around the general elections.[47] It recommended that Papua New Guinea review the Peace and Good Order Act (1991) and ensure that those responsible for excessive force or unlawful killings of protesters were promptly identified, charged and prosecuted. It recommended reviewing and updating human rights training for police and security forces to foster consistent application of international human rights standards, including the United Nations Basic Principles on the Use of Force and Firearms by Law Enforcement Officials.[48]

26. JS2 reported that human rights defenders, such as environmental activists and sexual orientation and gender identity rights defenders, faced risks to their liberty and security and to their rights to freedom of expression, association and peaceful assembly. It further raised concerns regarding arrests and detention of human rights defenders, and gender-based harassment and threats against women human rights defenders.[49] AI raised similar concerns regarding Indigenous communities and environmental human rights defenders operating in areas affected by extractive industries.[50]

27. JS2 referred to online space restrictions, and the use of the Cybercrime Act (2016) to silence criticism, creating a chilling effect. It reported that job dismissals and suspensions, including of journalists and media workers, had been used as a reprisal for critical reporting and that journalists faced bribery attempts, censorship, direct threats, intimidation and lawsuits, making journalism a dangerous profession. It warned that the National Media Development Policy could lead to more government control over Papua New Guinea's relatively free media.[51]

28. AI recommended that Papua New Guinea protect the rights of human rights defenders, and Indigenous communities, especially the right to freedom of expression, association and peaceful assembly.[52] JS2 recommended fostering a safe and enabling environment for civil society, preventing undue restrictions, ensuring effective investigations into attacks, harassment and intimidation, and reviewing criminal defamation provisions in the Cybercrime Act and their use against peaceful online expression.[53]

Prohibition of all forms of slavery, including trafficking in persons

29. ECLJ reported that many of the human trafficking victims were subjected to forced labour, sexual exploitation, forced marriages, child labour, and domestic servitude, and that children were heavily targeted by human traffickers. It added that many instances of human trafficking went unreported and not investigated. Law enforcement lacked the training and resources needed to identify victims of human trafficking, and in some cases, victims of human trafficking went unidentified or deported. ECLJ recommended that Papua New Guinea allocate resources and personnel dedicated to investigating and prosecuting human trafficking cases; implement procedures to identify victims of human trafficking and provide them with aid.[54]

Right to work and to just and favourable conditions of work

30. JS1 noted that the Employment Act (1978) prohibited discrimination against a female person on account of her sex. However, there were provisions that imposed restrictions on women's employment in certain industries and there was no specialised body that addressed gender discrimination in the workplace. There were no specific provisions directed towards sexual harassment in workplace. JS1 recommended that Papua New Guinea amend the Employment Act to meet obligations under ILO Convention No. 190 to define sexual harassment, require employers to have workplace policies and awareness programmes, and establish a reporting mechanism for sexual harassment complaints.[55]

31. JS3 reported that young people faced barriers in transitioning from education to employment and recommended that Papua New Guinea expand and strengthen school-to-work transition programmes; develop targeted youth employment and entrepreneurships; and invest in tailored technical and vocational education and training.[56]

Right to health

32. JS3 reported shortage in essential medicines and uneven access to quality healthcare, particularly in rural areas and other marginalized contexts. It further noted that mental health challenges were rarely addressed in a structured way. ICO reported that inequalities continued to undermine the right to health, with the most severe impacts experienced by Indigenous and minority communities living in rural, remote, and customary areas. ICO and JS3 recommended that Papua New Guinea invest in health infrastructure, particularly in underserved and remote areas. JS3 further recommended that the country strengthen mental health services and improve the availability and distribution of essential medicines.[57]

33. AI reported that Papua New Guinea was experiencing a surge in HIV infections, resulting in a national emergency declaration in June 2025, specifically with mother to child transmission being high.[58] CSOLC4UPR reported that health services collapsed when the fighting intensified in Hela and Enga,[59] and recommended that Papua New Guinea ensure continuity of HIV, tuberculosis, and chronic disease treatment through mobile and emergency health services.[60]

34. AI reported that abortion was highly restricted and only permitted when a woman's life was at risk. Safe abortions, even where legal, were often unavailable through the public health system, leaving women to resort to unsafe abortions. It added that there remained high levels of stigma and taboo on sexual and reproductive health care in Papua New Guinea. It recommended that abortion be fully decriminalized, and that universal access to safe abortion and sexual and reproductive and health rights to be ensured for all.[61] CCI held a divergent opinion in this regard.[62]

35. CCI reported high maternal mortality ratio. Two submissions recommended strengthening maternal health by improving access to skilled birth attendance and emergency

obstetric care, including through investment in the training and deployment of skilled birth attendants, including in conflict-affected areas. CCI further recommended strengthening rural health infrastructure. CSOLC4UPR additionally recommended ensuring access to antenatal and postnatal services for displaced women, including through mobile clinics, and publishing disaggregated data on maternal and infant mortality in conflict-affected provinces.[63]

Right to education

36. CCI referred to a report indicating that 72% of 10-year-olds in Papua New Guinea could not read or understand age-appropriate text, reflecting one of the highest learning-poverty levels in the Pacific. CCI and JS3 reported low primary school completion rates, and a sharp decline in transition to secondary education.[64] ICO noted significantly higher dropout rates and lower completion levels among children in rural, remote, and predominantly Indigenous provinces, reflecting persistent structural barriers to education access. It recommended that Papua New Guinea prioritise targeted interventions to reduce rural–urban disparities in school completion and learning outcomes.[65]

37. JS3 recommended enhanced access to quality education, including by addressing teacher shortages, strengthening student retention, and investing in teachers and educational infrastructure, especially in rural and underserved areas. It further recommended that Papua New Guinea introduce targeted financial support measures for vulnerable families to reduce the indirect costs of education and improve school attendance.[66]

38. JAI reported that violence and instability, including school closures, undermined access to education, while CSOLC4UPR reported that children in Hela and Enga had not attended school for over a year due to the ongoing fighting.[67] CSOLC4UPR recommended designating schools in conflict-affected areas as protected zones and rapidly reopen them, with catch-up learning programmes; establish child-friendly spaces and psychosocial support for displaced children.[68] Similarly, JAI recommended that Papua New Guinea ensure continuity of education in areas affected by violence, disasters, and extractive activities, including temporary learning arrangements and protection of schools.[69]

39. OceaniaHR recommended that Papua New Guinea work with regional and international civil society organizations to conduct trainings in human rights education and translate the international human rights instruments into Indigenous languages of its citizens.[70] ICO recommended expanding community-based civic education and human rights awareness programmes in local and minority languages.[71]

Development, the environment, and business and human rights

40. JS5 reported that Papua New Guinea continued to face serious challenges in protecting customary land rights and the environment despite constitutional recognition and previous UPR recommendations.[72] JS5 and JS6 reported that customary landowners held 97% of land,[73] yet large-scale resource extraction projects had repeatedly proceeded without the free, prior, and informed consent of affected communities.[74] JS5 reported a lack of contract transparency and accountability and that landowners were not adequately consulted or informed about project activities.[75] JAI reported that unresolved disputes linked to Special Agriculture and Business Leases reflected persistent weaknesses in land governance and contributed to land dispossession and rights violations.[76]

41. Three submissions recommended that Papua New Guinea enforce mandatory free, prior, and informed consent processes for development projects.[77] OceaniaHR further recommended that it consult customary landowners on the development of the National Action Plan on Human Rights with inclusion of Business and Human Rights.[78] JS5 recommended that Papua New Guinea provide fair compensation for business activities that negatively affect the land and resources of traditional landowners and promote the participation of local communities in decision-making processes relating to business sector development.[79] JAI recommended to fully resourcing anti-corruption institutions, particularly in relation to extractive sector governance and public revenue accountability.[80]

42. OceaniaHR reported that cultural heritage, including sacred and burial sites, continued to be destroyed without consultation or protection. Similar risks were present in coastal and

island regions where development threatened fragile ecosystems and customary tenure systems.[81] In this context, AI and OceanianHR recommended that Papua New Guinea support a moratorium on deep-sea mining to protect the rights to life, livelihoods and culture of coastal communities, including Indigenous communities.[82]

43. AI reported that Papua New Guinea was highly vulnerable to the effects of the climate crisis and required international assistance to support adaptation, mitigation and efforts to address loss and damage. It recommended that Papua New Guinea abolish carbon offset schemes that did not deliver real cuts in emissions, protecting forests and other natural resources, and ensure a just and equitable transition away from fossil fuels that provides greater social protection and sustainable and decent employment.[83]

44. JAI recommended that Papua New Guinea continue implementing the National Adaptation Plan with enhanced international financial and technical assistance under the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change, while prioritizing early warning systems, community-based disaster risk management, protection for climate-displaced populations, and stronger environmental rights and safeguards in the extractive sector. It added that climate adaptation and disaster response plans must integrate gender-sensitive protections, including heightened risks faced by displaced women and girls.[84]

45. AI reported that the Panguna mine site in Bougainville (closed since 1989) was subjected to a recent environmental impact assessment confirming major environmental damage and risks to communities. AI recommended that Papua New Guinea ensure that all duty bearers, including the Autonomous Bougainville and the Papua New Guinean governments and relevant corporate actors, uphold the right to an effective remedy for harms caused by extractive projects, and that new projects were only commenced after obtaining the free, prior and informed consent of Indigenous Peoples and were subject to publicly available environmental, social and human rights impact assessments.[85]

2. Rights of specific persons or groups

Women

46. Three submissions reported that violence against women and girl and gender-based violence was a persistent problem and widespread.[86] AI cited a 2025 survey indicating a 210% surge in reports of gender-based violence in the past three decades, and that 64% of women experienced intimate partner violence.[87] CSOLC4UPR noted that in Hela and Enga, sexual violence was used as a weapon, and that Papua New Guinea lacked monitoring mechanism for conflict-related sexual violence.[88]

47. AI added that, despite dedicated family and sexual violence police units, police lacked adequate capacity and resources to address the high rates of violence.[89] CCI reported that underreporting, limited enforcement, and reliance on informal justice mechanisms continued to undermine protection efforts.[90] JS6 reported that women with disabilities faced multiple barriers to reporting sexual violence and recommended enhancing penalties for perpetrators as a deterrent.[91]

48. JS1 recommended that Papua New Guinea continue efforts to eliminate gender-based violence, including domestic and sexual violence by strengthening accountability mechanisms and allocating sufficient budget to relevant programmes. It recommended amending legislation to criminalise all forms of gender-based violence, including sexual harassment, and amending sentencing legislation to clarify that gendered stereotypes, compensation, and reconciliation should not be taken into account in the sentencing process at any court level.[92] Similarly, JAI recommended that Papua New Guinea prioritize the enforcement of the Family Protection Act and Lukautim Pikinini Act (2015), adequately funding the National Gender-Based Violence Strategy, and expanding access to safe houses, legal aid, and Family and Sexual Violence Units nationwide.[93] AI recommended that Papua New Guinea ensure unrestricted access to shelters and provide adequate financial and human resources to support services, including for effective victim protection and free legal advice to access justice.[94]

49. JS6 recommended that Papua New Guinea implement public awareness campaigns to address harmful social norms that perpetuate gender-based violence, including campaigns targeting attitudes toward women with disabilities.[95]

50. AI reported that the age of consent for marriage remained at 16 (or 14 years with a court order) for girls while the age of marriage for boys was 18 (or 16 with a court order) and that early and forced marriage and the payment of bride price was common. It recommended that Papua New Guinea work with local communities to ensure that these harmful practices were abolished.[96]

Children

51. JAI reported that children faced systemic neglect, and that child protection laws were largely unenforced. It recommended that Papua New Guinea expand child-sensitive social protection and strengthen child protection laws, particularly in emergency and displacement contexts.[97]

52. CSOLC4UPR noted that family separation among displaced children heightened their vulnerability to exploitation and recruitment by violent groups and recommended that Papua New Guinea establish child-friendly spaces and psychosocial support for displaced children in the Highlands and in urban informal settlements.[98]

53. JS3 recommended that Papua New Guinea strengthen the legal framework for child protection by repealing Article 278 of the Criminal Code Act and explicitly prohibiting all forms of corporal punishment in all settings, including home, and expand community-based child protection systems.[99]

54. ICO recommended that Papua New Guinea expand access to birth registration and identity documentation through mobile outreach services in remote and rural areas.[100]

Persons with disabilities

55. JS6 reported that disability services were concentrated in urban centres, leaving people with disabilities in rural and remote areas with limited access to services, assistive devices, rehabilitation, or inclusive education. It recommended that Papua New Guinea conduct a national baseline disability survey, allocate dedicated funding for disability services, expand service delivery in rural and remote areas, and establish disability service centres in each province.[101]

56. JAI reported that persons with disabilities faced barriers to participation and inclusion, including limited access to disaster preparedness, humanitarian assistance and climate adaptation planning, and recommended that Papua New Guinea mainstream disability inclusion across these areas in line with the CRPD.[102]

Indigenous Peoples and minorities

57. ICO reported that the absence of disaggregated and minority-specific data limits the assessment of disparities affecting minority groups, and that unequal public resource distribution and marginalisation were drivers of conflict in certain communities. ICO recommended that Papua New Guinea strengthen data collection, conflict prevention strategies in high-risk areas, and meaningful participation of indigenous, rural and minority communities.[103]

58. JS5 recommended that Papua New Guinea formally domesticate and implement the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples and strengthen engagement with the Expert Mechanism on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples.[104] It further recommended developing legislation to fully recognize and protect Indigenous peoples' rights.[105] OceaniaHR similarly recommended upholding the United Nations Declaration on the Rights of Indigenous Peoples and including customary landowners in sustainable development projects.[106]

59. ICO reported that linguistic minority communities face language erosion, threatening cultural transmission and identity, and recommended that Papua New Guinea ensure

equitable access to healthcare, education and justice for speakers of minority and Indigenous languages and remove language-related barriers to participation.[107]

Lesbian, gay, bisexual, transgender and intersex persons

60. Several submissions noted the different challenges faced by LGBTQI people, such as violence, harassment, stigma, discrimination, exclusion and barriers to justice.[108] AI reported that Papua New Guinea's Constitution did not explicitly prohibit discrimination on the basis of sexual orientation and gender identity. It recommended that Papua New Guinea publicly reaffirm that all people have the right to live free from discrimination and violence based on their sexual orientation or gender identity and that acts of gender-based violence against LGBTI people will be prosecuted in accordance with the law.[109]

61. Three submissions recommended that Papua New Guinea decriminalize same-sex activity by repealing sections 210 and 212 of the Criminal Code Act.[110] JS6 recommended to explicitly criminalise violence and discrimination on the basis of sexual orientation and gender identity and to strengthen the Cybercrime Act (2016) to cover online harassment, cyberbullying, and digital violence.[111]

Migrants, refugees and asylum-seekers

62. AI recommended that Papua New Guinea immediately end offshore detention and processing of refugees and asylum seekers and ensure that asylum seekers were transferred or resettled in a country where they were safe, in accordance with the principle of non-refoulement.[112]

63. JAI reported that the absence of legal recognition left West Papuan refugees with limited access to healthcare, education, and livelihoods, although some had obtained special citizenship through special provisions. It recommended that Papua New Guinea provide legal recognition and access to basic rights and services to West Papuan refugees, consistent with international refugee and human rights standards.[113]

Internally displaced persons

64. CSOLC4UPR reported that displacement was widespread, and that it increased following violence associated with 2022 elections. It reported the absence of a formal policy, legal framework or coordinated support for internally displaced persons, leaving them without legal status, protection or adequate assistance. It recommended that Papua New Guinea adopt a national policy on internally displaced persons consistent with the United Nations Guiding Principles on Internal Displacement; establish a coordinated humanitarian response in conflict-affected areas, including registration, shelter, food and basic services; and ensure safe and voluntary return or other durable solutions, including access to land, livelihoods and psychosocial support.[114]

3. Specific regions or territories

65. OceaniaHR reported that the unresolved political status of Bougainville required attention to ensure the enjoyment of human rights, particularly the right to self-determination.[115] JAI noted that, although Papua New Guinea and Bougainville agreed in 2021 to a roadmap envisioning the conclusion of consultations and a political settlement between 2025 and 2027, progress had been slow and uncertain. It warned that prolonged delays could undermine confidence in the peace process. It stated that timely and good-faith engagement by the National Parliament was essential to uphold the right to self-determination and preserve peace. JAI called on Papua New Guinea to make measurable progress towards resolving Bougainville's political status in good faith and in accordance with the Bougainville Peace Agreement and prevent renewed conflict.[116] OceaniaHR similarly recommended that Papua New Guinea recommit to peace, and justice and conflict resolution mechanisms that support the realization of human rights, including the right of self-determination.[117]

Notes

[1] A/HRC/49/11 and the addendum A/HRC/49/11/Add.1, and A/HRC/49/2.

[2] The stakeholders listed below have contributed information for this summary; the full texts of all original submissions are available at: www.ohchr.org.

Civil society

Individual submissions:

AI	Amnesty International, London (United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland);
CCI	Christian Council International, Bodegraven (Netherlands);
CGNK	Center for Global Nonkilling, Geneva (Switzerland);
CSOLC4UPR	Magna carta PNG Inc, Port Moresby (Papua New Guinea);
ECLJ	European Centre for Law and Justice, Strasbourg (France);
ICAN	International Campaign to Abolish Nuclear Weapons, Geneva (Switzerland);
ICO	International Communities Organisation, London (United Kingdom of Great Britain and Northern Ireland);
JAI	Just Atonement Inc., New York (United States of America);
OceaniaHR	Oceania Human Rights, Suva (Fiji).

Joint submissions:

JS1	**Joint submission 1 submitted by:** The International Center for Advocates Against Discrimination (ICAAD), Chappaqua (United States of America); and the Papua New Guinea Business Coalition for Women;
JS2	**Joint submission 2 submitted by:** CIVICUS: World Alliance for Citizen Participation, Johannesburg (South Africa); Pacific Islands Association of Non-Government Organisations (PIANGO); and Transparency International Papua New Guinea (TIPNG);
JS3	**Joint submission 3 submitted by:** Marist International Solidarity Foundation (FMSI), Rome (Italy); Marist Brothers – Star of the Sea Province;
JS4	**Joint submission 4 submitted by:** Magna Carta PNG Inc, Port Moresby (Papua New Guinea); IIMA – Istituto Internazionale Maria Ausiliatrice delle Salesiane di Don Bosco; VIDES International – International Volunteerism Organization for Women,Education and Development; Daughters of Mary Help of Christians (Salesian Sisters of St. John Bosco) – FMA Philippines–Papua New Guinea Province;
JS5	**Joint submission 5 submitted by:** Papua Native Landowners Association Incorporated (PNLA), Port Moresby (Papua New Guinea); IIMA – Istituto Internazionale Maria Ausiliatrice delle Salesiane di Don Bosco; Vide Internazionale4. Daughters of Mary Help of Christians (Salesian Sisters of St John) - FMA Philippines Papua New Guinea Province; Badiri Vamaga Clan ILG; Motu Koita Assembly; and Humanity and Nature Indigenous Women's Association Inc.;
JS6	**Joint submission 6 submitted by:** Advancing PNG Women's Leaders Network (APNGWLN); Magna Carta PNG Incorporated (MCPNGI); Papua Native Landowners Association Incorporated (PNLA); Assemblies of the Disabled Persons (ADP); PNG Counsellors Association Incorporated (PNGCA); Humanity and Nature Indigenous Women (PHASF);
JS7	**Joint submission 7 submitted by:** Hetura Network PNG Association Inc, Port Moresby (Papua New Guinea); and Key Population Advocacy Consortium PNG (KPAC).;
JS8	**Joint submission 8 submitted by:** Parliamentarians for Global Action, New York (United States of America); Global Initiative Against Impunity for International Crimes and Serious Human Rights Violations;
JS9	**Joint submission 9 submitted by:** Capital Punishment Justice Project, Melbourne (Australia); Anti-Death Penalty Asia Network, World Coalition Against the Death Penalty, Parliamentarians for Global Action and The Advocates for Human Rights;

JS10 **Joint submission 10 submitted by:** VIVAT International, Geneva (Switzerland); and Melanesian Institute for Pastoral and Socio-Economic Services Inc.

[3] AI, p. 4, see also: OceaniaHR, p. 2, and JAI, p. 1.
[4] JS9, p. 7.
[5] JS5, p. 14.
[6] ECLJ, p. 5.
[7] JS8, p. 3
[8] ICAN, p. 1.
[9] JS2, p. 16.
[10] JS6, p. 9.
[11] AI, p. 2; JAI, p. 2; and JS1, p. 2.
[12] AI, p. 4.; JAI, p. 7, JS2, p. 14, JS6, p.8.
[13] ICO, p. 5.
[14] JAI, p. 7.
[15] JS3, p. 4, see also: JAI, p. 7.
[16] AI p. 2 and JS3, p. 4.
[17] ICO, p. 2, CSOLC4UPR, p. 5., JS1, p. 9, and JS6, p. 9.
[18] ICO, p. 7.
[19] AI, p. 3.
[20] AI, pp. 2 and 4.
[21] JS4, p. 4.
[22] AI, p. 3.
[23] CSOLC4UPR, p. 3.
[24] AI, p. 3.
[25] AI, p. 5.
[26] CSOLC4UPR, p. 4.
[27] JAI, p. 7.
[28] CSOLC4UPR, p. 3
[29] JS10, pp. 1–2, see also: ICO, p. 7, JS1, p. 4, and JS3, p. 11.
[30] JS3,p. 11, JS6, pp. 5–6.
[31] JS6, p. 6 and JS10, p. 3.
[32] JS1, p. 8 and JS6, p. 6.
[33] JS1, pp. 2 and 8, JS3, p. 12. JS6, p. 6, and JS10, p. 3, see also: ICO, p. 7.
[34] JS3, p.12, JS10, p. 3.
[35] AI, pp. 3 and 5, JS1, p. 9, JS10, p. 3, JS6, p.6.
[36] AI, pp. 3 and 5.
[37] CGNK, p. 3–5.
[38] JAI, p. 3.
[39] AI, p. 2.
[40] JAI, p. 3.
[41] JAI, p. 7.
[42] JS4, pp. 4–5.
[43] JS4, pp. 3–4 and JS6, p. 8.
[44] JS6, p.8.
[45] AI, p. 3.
[46] ICO, p. 5.
[47] JS2 pp. 12–13.
[48] JS2, pp. 12–13 and 15–16.
[49] JS2, pp. 5–6.
[50] AI, p. 4.
[51] JS2, pp. 8–9.
[52] AI, p. 5.
[53] JS2, pp. 14–15.
[54] ECLJ, pp. 25.
[55] JS1, pp. 7 and 9.
[56] JS3, pp. 7–8.
[57] ICO, pp. 2 and 6, JS3, p. 9–10.
[58] AI, p. 3.
[59] CSOLC4UPR, pp. 4–5.
[60] CSOLC4UPR, p. 5.

[61] AI, pp. 3–4.
[62] CCI, pp. 2–4.
[63] CCI, pp. 1 and 3, CSOLC4UPR, p. 5.
[64] CCI, p. 4, JS3, p. 2.
[65] ICO, p. 6.
[66] JS3, p. 7.
[67] CSOLC4UPR, p. 5 and JAI, p. 4.
[68] CSOLC4UPR, p. 6.
[69] JAI, p. 8.
[70] OceaniaHR p. 2.
[71] ICO, p. 5.
[72] JS5, p.3.
[73] JS5, p. 3 and JS6, p. 7.
[74] JS6, p. 7.
[75] JS5, p. 8.
[76] JAI, p. 3.
[77] ICO, p. 3, JS5, p. 5 and 14, JS6, p. 7, see also: OceaniaHR, p. 3.
[78] OceaniaHR, p. 3.
[79] JS5, p. 8.
[80] JAI, p. 7.
[81] OceaniaHR p. 3.
[82] AI, p. 5.
[83] AI, pp. 4–5.
[84] JAI, p.8.
[85] AI, pp. 4–5.
[86] AI, p. 3, CSOLC4UPR, p. 2–3, and JS1, p. 2.
[87] AI, p. 3.
[88] CSOLC4UPR, pp. 3 and 7.
[89] AI, p. 3.
[90] CCI, p. 3.
[91] JS6, p. 8.
[92] JS1, pp. 2 and 9.
[93] JAI, p. 8, see also: JS1, p. 9.
[94] AI, p.5, see also: JS1, p. 3.
[95] JS6, p. 6.
[96] AI, pp. 3 and 5.
[97] JAI, pp. 4 and 8.
[98] CSOLC4UPR, p. 5–6.
[99] JS3, p. 12.
[100] ICO, p. 5.
[101] JS6, pp. 6–7.
[102] JAI, pp. 4 and 8.
[103] ICO, pp. 1–2.
[104] JS5, p. 9.
[105] JS5, p. 14.
[106] OceaniaHR, p. 3.
[107] ICO, p. 2.
[108] AI, p.3; JAI, p.4; JS4, p. 4, JS6, pp. 8–9 and JS7 p. 13.
[109] AI, pp. 3 and 5.
[110] AI, p. 5; JS6, p. 9; and JS7, p. 9.
[111] JS6, p. 9, see also: JS7 p. 9.
[112] AI, p. 5.
[113] JAI, pp.4 and 9.
[114] CSOLC4UPR, p. 4.
[115] OceaniaHR, p. 3.
[116] JAI, pp. 6–7 and 9.
[117] OceaniaHR, p. 3.